This was, of course, not an original idea or a new initiative. Every governor before me had his own way of engaging with the editors—some met them casually and individually, others met them in small, informal groups. My strategy was to have an annual editors' conference with about fifteen–twenty editors for an in-depth discussion—'background' in media parlance.

Since the format was untested, the first time we organized the conference, in August 2010, we prepared an agenda indicating the topics for discussion. The objective behind the preselecting of topics was only to keep the discussion focused and prevent it from going all over the map. Some editors did not like this idea and thought that my 'control freak' disciplining of the format inhibited a free-flowing discussion. On the other hand, I was not comfortable with a total 'stream of consciousness' style of discussion as it might muffle our understanding and even distort the messages. We agreed on a compromise. Ahead of the conference, the Reserve Bank would provide the participants with a long menu which we would narrow down to three or four topics in consultation with the invitees. We will devote one half of the meeting to discuss the preselected topics, while the remaining half will be spent on a free-flowing conversation.

A host of issues figured on the agenda of these conferences. They ranged from hot-button issues like the monetary policy stance and exchange rate management to regulation of microfinance institutions and deregulation of the interest on savings deposits, allowing corporates into the banking space and the FSLRC (Financial Sector Legislative Reforms Commission) and the FSDC (Financial Stability and Development Council). The meetings were held under the Chatham House Rule—the editors could use the discussion at the conference to write their commentary or opinion without any attribution to the Reserve Bank. Needless to say, I found these meetings not only enjoyable but immensely rewarding.

Over the years I spent at the Reserve Bank, I developed an enormous respect for the media not only for the role they play in enhancing the effectiveness of Reserve Bank policies, but even more importantly for the role they play in making the Reserve Bank accountable. I was also